

★ **ONE PLAY EARLY** in the game quite often decides the final score, but is overlooked by many fans when they see the final score is 7-3.

That was the story of Minneapolis' opening loss to an Indianapolis team that hadn't been doing too well until it moved into the Metropolitan stadium Thursday.

True, Stu Miller, with his tantalizing stuff, lacked his normal control. Without that, he loses quite a little of his effectiveness.

He got away to a bad start with two runs by the Hoosiers in the first. However, he appeared to be settling down in the third when THE play of the game happened.

With one out and runners on first and second, one

Lowdown on Sports

By CHARLES JOHNSON

through a clean hit and another on a flubber through the box that Miller should not have tried to field, the

Indianapolis pitcher laid down a bunt.

It was an easy force play at third with the possibility of a double play at first. With plenty of time, Miller threw the ball into left field. Two runs scored and the Indians were out in front 5-2 never to be headed.

Miller regained his control. It was too late. Whereas the score should have been 3-3 through five, it was 5-3 and later 7-3 as weak pinch-hitters could do nothing for the home team.

YET THE final score sounded like it was an easy touch for Andy Cohen and his Indians.

Out of that first game came more evidence that the Millers are quite a pathetic hitting outfit when Hank Thompson and Carlos Paula are on the bench. Even with them in there regularly, more punch probably will have to be added.

Bright spots were Jim Davenport's actions in the field, Orlando Cepeda's two line drive smashes, the defensive play of the infield and good attitude by the entire Miller squad.

Red Davis' outfield is almost certain to need some repairing defensively. The pitching eventually will need strengthening, too, to make this team a pennant contender in an American Association that may have more weak outfits in the second division than usual.

☆ ☆ ☆

Andy Cohen was having a great time masterminding in between handshakes Thursday. He even trapped the Miller infield on a squeeze play in the ninth.

☆ ☆ ☆